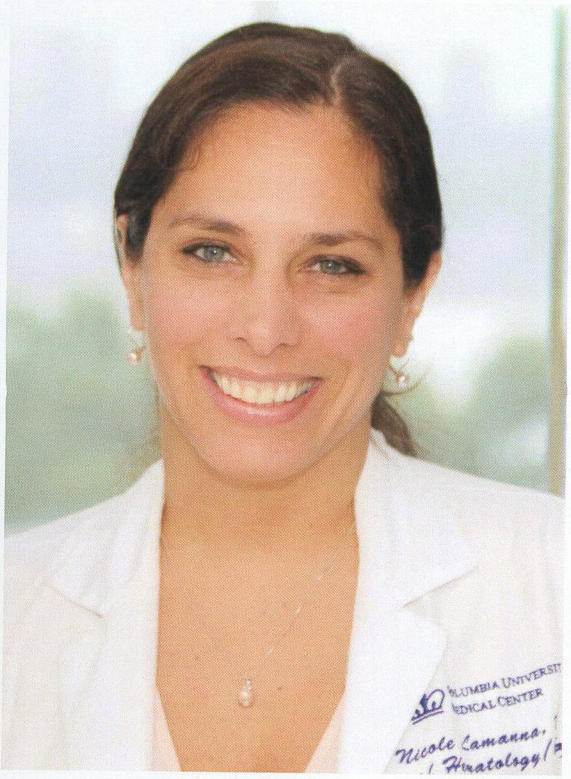
NICOLE LAMANNA, MD



Dr. Lamanna is a pioneering investigator and internationally recognized leader in CLL. As the inaugural incumbent of the Judy Horrigan Professorship of Medicine, she has been able to expand Columbia's CLL research efforts, raise the public profile of the diagnosis, and pursue the most promising avenues of research for its treatment.

Her work has been widely published in peer-reviewed journals including *Blood*, *The New England Journal of Medicine*, *The Journal of Clinical Oncology*, *eJHaem*, *Blood Advances*, and *Clinical Lymphoma, Myeloma & Leukemia*, which have informed both academic research and frontline patient care.

Dr. Lamanna has also been an invited speaker at major national and international forums, including the American Society of Hematology (ASH) Annual Meeting, the European Hematology Association (EHA), and the Society of Hematologic Oncology (SOHO), where she has presented on cutting-edge developments in targeted therapies, emerging agents, and personalized approaches to CLL treatment.

Dr. Lamanna's combination of groundbreaking research, clinical expertise, paradigm-shifting approaches to the diagnosis, and substantial track record of progress are singular – and she and her team are transforming the ways in which we think about the diagnosis. CLL has shifted from a disease with a dire prognosis to a chronic condition that can be treated for the duration of a patient's life. Although curative therapy remains a goal, many CLL patients can now live to an average life expectancy due to many of the therapies currently FDA-approved through trials Dr. Lamanna has led at Columbia.

In addition, Dr. Lamanna is a staunch patient advocate and continues to educate at patient symposiums, aiming to help patients understand their disease, ask the right questions of their providers, and seek guidance if they do not have access to a CLL expert. She prides herself not only in the cutting-edge treatment she can offer her CLL patients through her clinical trial efforts, but also the excellent care her patients receive from her and her team.

LILI WANG, MD, MS, PhD

We are very pleased to be able to share the news that Lili Wang, MD, MS, PhD, an exceptional scientist, educator, mentor and collaborator, will be the inaugural Roberts Family Professor of Medicine (in Hematology-Oncology and the Herbert Irving Comprehensive Cancer Center). Your support has been absolutely indispensable in her recruitment and arrival at VP&S. Working in tandem with Dr. Lamanna, Dr. Wang will help us expand the breadth and influence of our work in CLL, ratifying our leadership role in both the clinical work and pioneering research in chronic lymphotic leukemia.

Dr. Wang's work focuses particularly on the role of RNA metabolism in CLL and related diagnoses – she is especially interested in mutations in splicing factors and regulators that control RNA epigenetics – that is, the changes in the expressions of genes, which do not alter the genes themselves. Her aim is to identify the molecular consequences of aberrant RNA processing, and then to use that knowledge to develop more effective, targeted treatments for leukemia and lymphoma.

Dr. Wang received her MD from China Medical University, followed by an MS in immunology from the same institution, and then completed her PhD in immunology at Tokai University in Japan. She subsequently completed two postdoctoral fellowships: from 2003 to 2008 at the University of Illinois (Chicago) under Dr. Amy Kenter; and from 2008 to 2013 at Dana Farber Cancer Institute (DFCI), under the renowned Dr. Catherine Wu.

She was then Instructor of Medicine at DFCI from 2013 until 2017, when she was recruited to Beckman Research Institute City of Hope, where she served as an associate professor (2017-2023) and then as a full professor with tenure.

BRANDON DaSILVA, MD

We are very pleased to introduce the new fellow who will be working under Dr. Lamanna's mentorship.

Dr. Brandon DaSilva is a second-year hematology oncology fellow who will be dedicating two years of clinical research time in the CLL program. He received his BS from Georgetown, and his MD from the State University of New York Downstate Medical Center College of Medicine.

Dr. DaSilva is going to spearhead a new investigator-initiated multicenter clinical trial, evaluating the addition of a novel agent to eradicate measurable residual disease in CLL patients who have received frontline standard-of-care therapy.

ANDREW H. LIPSKY, MD

Dr. Andrew Lipsky is an Assistant Professor of Medicine at Columbia University Medical Center who specializes in treating chronic lymphocytic leukemia and lymphoma. He has expanded the CLL program to Westchester, broadening patients' access to leading research and comprehensive care. His research focuses on cancer genomics and the development of new therapies for CLL, leveraging advanced bioinformatics to study how cancer cells evolve during treatment and translating those insights into innovative clinical trials and treatments.

KATHERINE BLOOMER

Katherine Bloomer is the Senior Program Coordinator for the Leukemia Service and CLL Program. She supports the program both administratively and on a research level by facilitating the care patients with hematologic malignancies receive. Her administrative work focuses on advancing the program's programmatic growth, streamlining communications, and supporting the team's activities. On the research front, Katherine focuses on CLL clinical trials and biorepository recruitment, building the foundation of clinical data and biospecimens that contribute to expanded research, the development of new treatments, and strengthened cross-institutional collaboration.

The Judy Horrigan CLL Strategic Research Fund

As you know, our goals are ambitious as we would like to make this chronic disease curable. For so long, progress in cancer research was intermittent and incremental, but now we truly are in a moment of remarkable scientific and medical discovery, with tools and insights available to our researchers that would have been unimaginable even just a few years ago. Some of the crucial projects funded by the Horrigan CLL Strategic Research Fund include: